

RHYTHM CHANGES 101

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #82

After the Blues, Rhythm Changes is probably the most important musical form and set of chord changes there is in jazz. If you are going to play jazz or try to understand it, you are going to be working with Rhythm Changes. Here at Digging Deeper, we are going to look at three different approaches to Rhythm Changes, beginning here with a Diatonic Approach (playing in the key of).

Put simply, Rhythm Changes is in the key of the first chord, very often Bb concert. Many famous melodies, licks, melodic devices and solos are 100% diatonic, using the Bb major scale, or the Bb pentatonic scale. This is a great approach to being with, but it's also a great approach for advanced players to develop further.

Lester Leaps In (Lester Young) - first 8 measures

Chord progression for Lester Leaps In (Lester Young) - first 8 measures:

Measures 1-4: Bbmaj7, Gm7, Cm7, F7

Measures 5-8: Bbmaj7, Gm7, Cm7, F7

The notation shows a melody in Bb major, starting with a half note Bb, followed by quarter notes Bb, A, G, F, E, D, C, Bb. The melody is repeated in measures 5-8.

Salt Peanuts (Dizzy Gillespie) - first 8 measures

Chord progression for Salt Peanuts (Dizzy Gillespie) - first 8 measures:

Measures 1-4: Bbmaj7, Gm7, Cm7, F7

Measures 5-8: Bbmaj7, Gm7, Cm7, F7

The notation shows a melody in Bb major, starting with a half note Bb, followed by quarter notes Bb, A, G, F, E, D, C, Bb. The melody is repeated in measures 5-8.